1 · Understanding the problem

What is the brief really asking?

Sprout 2.0 is an investing app for first-time investors in India, starting from ₹100. I have to design the homepage (mobile and desktop) and the first 5 onboarding screens so they feel like one story with one mascot. The limits are strict: a 3-week launch, 1 front-end developer, a page under 1.5 MB, animation under 100 KB, WCAG AA, 44px tap targets, and a 12px risk disclaimer above the fold. I read the brief as a test of how I think with messy data and different people wanting different things, not only how the screens look.

The real funnel

40,000 app downloads

↓ only 22.5% start and finish KYC (31,000 people lost, **the biggest leak**)

9,000 did KYC · 22.5%

↓ 33.3% of KYC users make a first investment

3,000 first investments · 7.5%

> **My reading:** the app is not losing people at the investing step, it is losing them **before KYC**. So the design effort should go to the homepage promise, the first screens and the KYC + waiting screens. The brief also says 62% drop off in KYC. I treated this as a second leak inside the KYC step (people who start but do not finish). The brief does not define it exactly, so I note this as an assumption.

Problem statement

First-time investors leave before finishing KYC because they feel worried and are not prepared (no PAN or Aadhaar ready, and a waiting screen that looks like the app has crashed).

How might we help a nervous first-timer reach their first ₹100 investment without feeling lost, while keeping the page light and the legal text clear?

Clues from Support complaints

- Users start KYC without PAN or Aadhaar ready, then quit.
- The waiting screen looks like a crash, so they close the app.

These two complaints decided most of my design: a "keep these ready" list and a calm waiting screen.

2 · Data audit

Which numbers I trusted and which I questioned

Every number in the brief has a weakness, so I wrote what it says, why it may be wrong and what I assumed.

Metric	What it says	Why it may be wrong	What I assumed
78% bounce rate	Most visitors leave the homepage fast.	Includes a paid ad campaign, so lots of low-intent clicks. The number is inflated.	Look at bounce for organic and paid traffic separately. Still keep the hero short and clear.
62% KYC drop-off	Most people who start KYC do not finish.	No cause is given. Could be missing documents, fear, or the waiting screen.	Use Support complaints as the best clue. Fix preparation and the wait.
91% mobile	Almost everyone is on a phone.	Looks reliable, but does not say which phones or browsers.	Design mobile first, desktop second.
40% on phones under ₹10,000	Many low-end phones.	Is it 40% of visitors or of downloaders? Not clear.	Keep animations small, avoid heavy images.
6.2 s load on 4G	The page is slow.	Average only, real users on weak signal may be much slower.	Treat speed as a design problem: one font, SVG, no video.
"Many" prefer Hindi	Some users want Hindi.	"Many" is not a number. Cannot decide how big this is.	Make the layout Hindi-ready (30% longer text) but launch English first, as the brief says.
Survey, n = 40	What users say they want.	Only 40 people and only existing users. Misses those who dropped off.	Use as a weak signal. Plan a new survey of people who left.
65% say investing feels scary	Fear is common.	No source or sample size shown in the brief.	Use it for tone (calm, plain words), not as a hard fact.

Trusted most: the funnel counts (40,000 → 9,000 → 3,000) and the mobile share, because they are plain counts from the app. **Trusted least:** the bounce rate and the survey.

What I decided because of this

- Fix the leak before KYC first, not the last step.
- Keep the page small and simple for low-end phones.
- Do not make big claims about Hindi, but do not design a layout that breaks later.
- Suggest real research with dropped users as the next step (page 11).

3 · Users

Two simple personas

I had no interviews, so these are made from clues in the brief (low-end phones, Hindi preference, fear, Support complaints). They are assumptions, not real people.

R — Riya, 22

Fresher, just got her first job offer

Situation

Uses a ₹8,000 Android phone on 4G with limited data. Saw a Sprout ad on Instagram. Has ₹500 to try.

Wants

- To start small and learn.
- An app that loads quickly.
- To know what is needed before she begins.

Worries

- "What if I lose money?"
- "Is my Aadhaar data okay here?"
- Her PAN card is at home, not with her.

What helps her

A short list of what to keep ready, a clear time estimate, and the option to save and come back.

S — Sunil, 34

Runs a shop in a small town

Situation

Prefers Hindi. Heard about investing from a cousin. Phone has little storage. Not sure if his mobile is linked to Aadhaar.

Wants

- Plain words without jargon.
- Big buttons and big text.
- To know a real person can help.

Worries

- Feels investing is "for rich people".
- Fears he will press a wrong button.
- Gets nervous if a screen freezes.

What helps him

Simple labels, a "why we ask" note, a support link, and a layout that will still fit Hindi text.

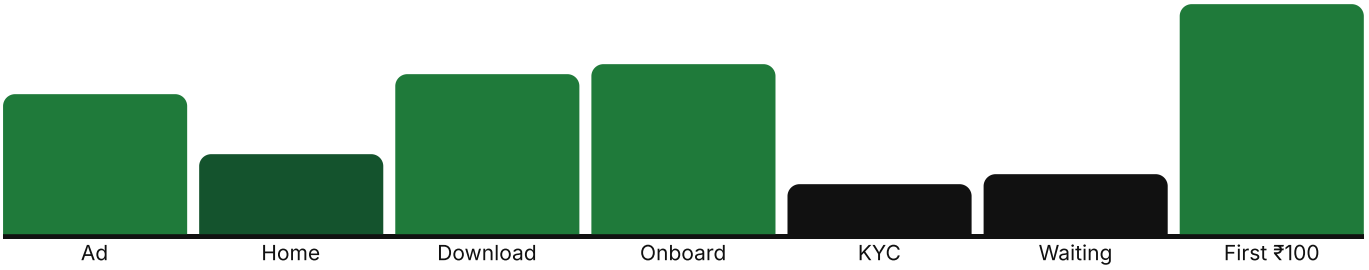
> **What both have in common:** they feel nervous and unprepared. That is why the mascot is a calm helper that explains things at the moments where people usually quit.

4 · Journey

User journey and where people drop off

Stage	What the user does	Feeling	Drop-off risk	My design answer
Ad / search	Sees an ad or searches "invest ₹100".	Curious	Low	Message must be clear and honest, no big promises.
Homepage	Reads the headline, looks for trust.	Unsure	High (78% bounce)	One headline, one button, disclaimer in the hero, trust chips, light page.
Download	Installs the app on a weak phone.	Hopeful	Medium	Keep the app small. Homepage says what to expect.
Onboarding	Opens app, picks language, sign up with OTP.	Interested	Medium	Mascot welcome, "keep these ready" screen, big inputs.
KYC	Needs PAN and Aadhaar.	Anxious	Very high (62%)	Progress bar, "why we ask", option to save and return.
Waiting	Looks at the verification screen.	Worried	High	Mascot waits with a clock, time estimate, "we will notify you".
First ₹100	Picks an option and invests.	Proud	Medium	Celebration moment, then referral idea.

How the feeling changes (simple view)



Taller bar = feels more positive. The two black bars (KYC and waiting) are the lowest points, so those screens get the most care. This is my own estimate, not measured data.

> The journey shows that the mood falls hardest right at KYC and the wait. So the mascot and the "calm" wording are placed exactly there.

5 · Stakeholder decisions

Who wants what, and what I chose

Who	Ask	Conflicts with	My decision	Reason
CEO	Minimal, premium look. No cartoon.	Marketing's fun mascot	Mascot is a simple geometric seedling (circle + leaf), not a cartoon. Only 3 colours, lots of white space.	Investing feels scary to many users. A calm guide builds trust and still looks grown-up.
Head of Marketing	Mascot, video, live ticker, 3 pop-ups, referral banner.	Page weight, CEO's minimal look, speed	Keep the mascot (4 states). Drop video, ticker and pop-ups. Referral banner moves to after the first investment, with the mascot celebrating.	6.2 s load and many low-end phones. Pop-ups on mobile hurt trust. The referral works better when the user has just had a good moment.
Compliance	12px+ disclaimer above the fold. No banned words.	A clean hero	Disclaimer is a styled strip inside the hero and on every investing screen. Wording like "start small", "regulated", "you stay in control".	Legal requirement. Not negotiable.
Lead Developer	Under 1.5 MB, animation under 100 KB, 1 dev for 3 weeks.	Marketing extras, many custom screens	SVG mascot (~1.3 KB each), one font, reusable parts (button, input, card, chip, disclaimer strip), only 5 onboarding screens.	The 3-week launch is fixed, so fewer parts = more chance to ship on time.
Customer Support	Fewer people stuck. Waiting screen must not look like a crash.	None. Supports the KYC fix	"Keep these ready" list on homepage and screen 2. Waiting screen has mascot, time estimate, notify option and a help button.	Directly targets the biggest leak and the top complaints.

What I did not do

- **Not everyone gets everything.** Saying yes to video, ticker and three pop-ups would break the 1.5 MB limit and the 3-week plan.
- **A live ticker** can look like it is promising returns, which also worries Compliance. Another reason to drop it.
- **Video** can come later as an A/B test after launch if the page is fast enough.

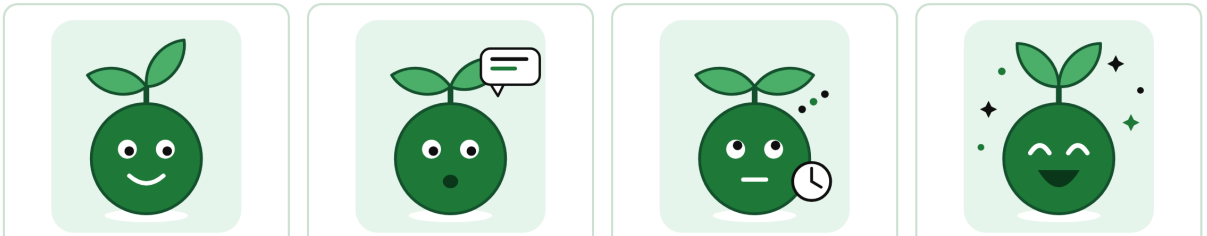
> **Compromise summary:** CEO gets the calm look, Marketing keeps the mascot and a celebration moment, Compliance gets the disclaimer everywhere, Dev gets a small light build, Support gets the checklist and the wait screen.

6 · Mascot and visual direction

Sprout, the calm seedling guide

Sprout mascot, 4 states

Simple circle body + stem + two leaves. Built as SVG, each file is about 1.3 KB.



1. Welcome
Smiles and waves. Used on homepage and screen 1.

2. Explaining
Open mouth and a speech card. Used on screen 2 and the "why we ask" help.

3. Waiting
Looks up with a clock. Used on screen 5 so the wait never looks like a crash.

4. Celebrating
Leaves up and sparkles. Used after verification and the first ₹100.

The same body, leaves and colours in all four states. Only the face and small props change, so it feels like one character from homepage to screen 5.

Why a seedling?

It matches the name "Sprout", small money growing slowly. It is just a circle, a stem and two leaves, so it is easy to draw, easy to animate and not childish. It stays small on the homepage and gets bigger only on onboarding screens where users feel nervous.

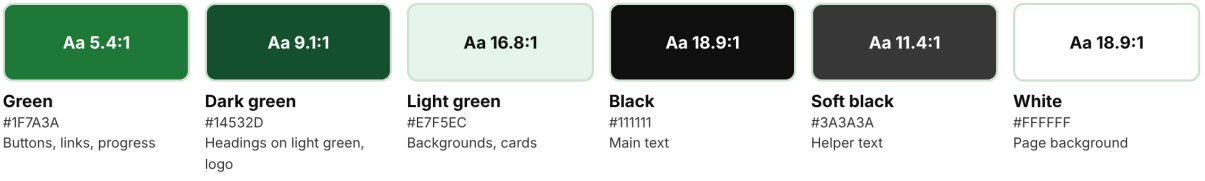
How it will be built

SVG for stills (each about 1.3 KB). The waiting animation can be a small Lottie file (budget 40 KB, limit 100 KB) or a simple CSS blink of the dots and clock.

Style guide

Style guide

Only green, white and black. Number on each swatch is the contrast ratio of the text on it (AA needs 4.5:1, large text 3:1).



Green
#1F7A3A
Buttons, links, progress

Dark green
#14532D
Headings on light green, logo

Light green
#E7F5EC
Backgrounds, cards

Black
#111111
Main text

Soft black
#3A3A3A
Helper text

White
#FFFFFF
Page background

Type scale

Heading 1 · 30 / 38

Heading 2 · 22 / 28

Heading 3 · 18 / 24

Body · 16 / 24 (never smaller on mobile)

Helper text · 14 / 20

Risk disclaimer · 12 / 17 (minimum allowed)

Mockups use Poppins and Inter as stand-ins. Final font: Noto Sans (supports Hindi).

Buttons

Primary button

Secondary button

Height 52px (min 44px). Width stretches, so longer Hindi labels wrap instead of breaking.

Chips

Selected | Option | Soon

Inputs

Label (always above the box)

Typed text

Helper text sits below. Input height 52px, border 2px black.

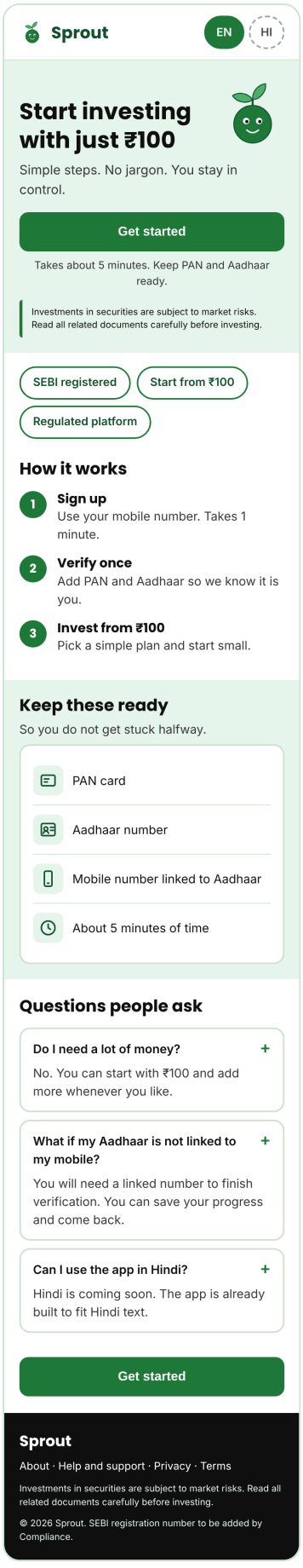
Spacing

Steps of 4 / 8 / 12 / 16 / 20 / 24. Screen side padding 20px. Corner radius 10 to 14px.

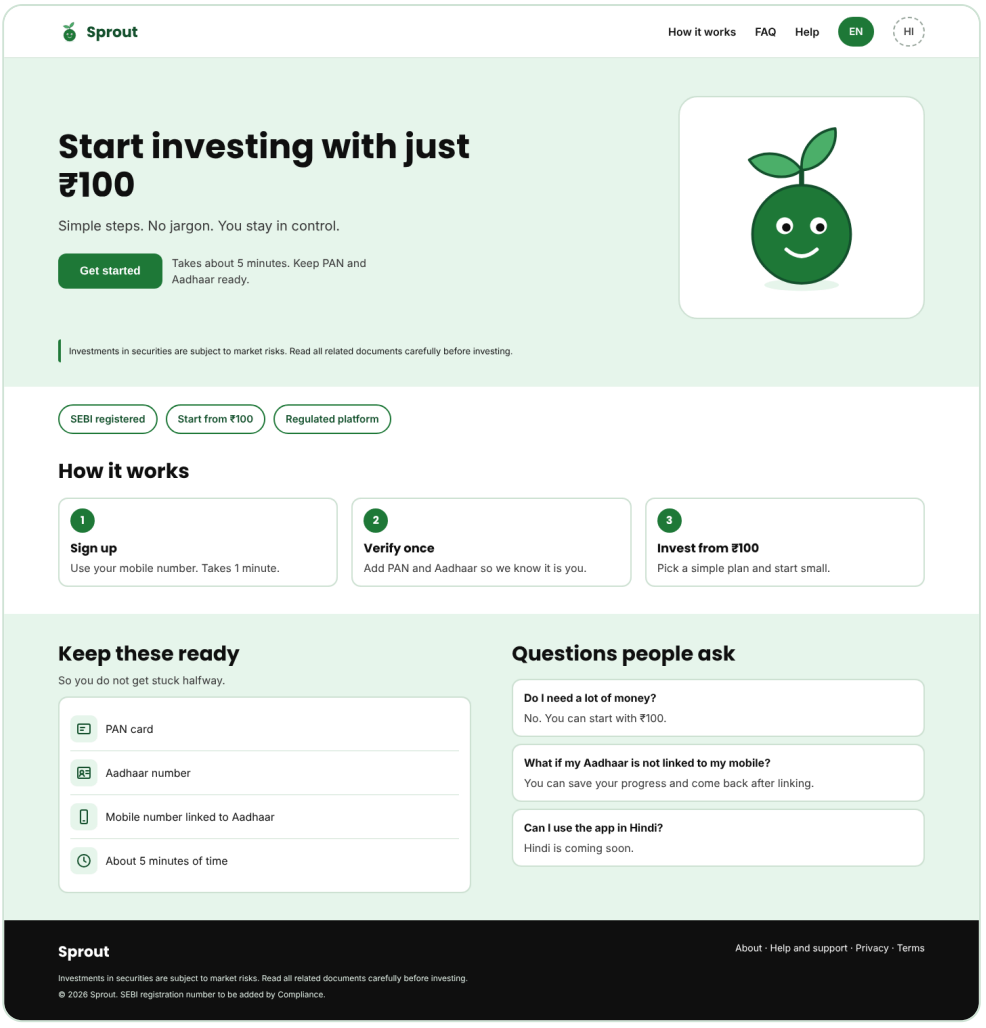
All text colours pass WCAG AA (normal text 4.5:1, large 3:1). The lighter leaf green (#4CAF6A) is used only for decoration, never for text.

7 · Homepage

Homepage, mobile first



Mobile, 390px wide



Desktop, 1440px wide: same content in wider blocks

What is on it, from top to bottom

1. **Hero:** one message ("Start investing with just ₹100"), one button, the mascot, and the disclaimer strip visible without scrolling.
2. **Trust chips:** SEBI registered, start from ₹100, regulated platform.
3. **How it works:** 3 simple steps.
4. **Keep these ready:** PAN, Aadhaar, linked mobile, 5 minutes. This is for the KYC problem.
5. **FAQ:** money needed, Aadhaar not linked, Hindi.
6. **Footer:** links and the disclaimer again.

Why this order

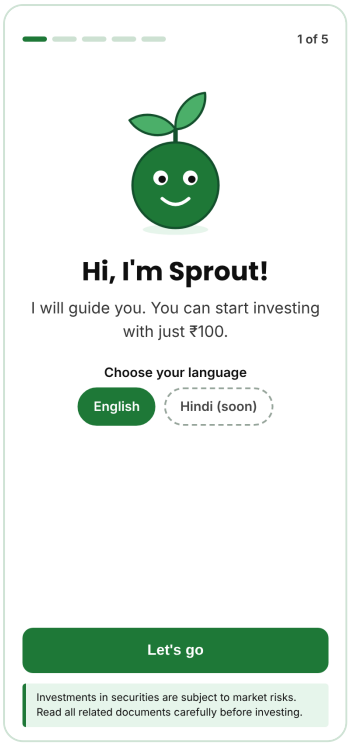
People decide in a few seconds (78% leave fast), so the top has only one idea. Trust comes right after, then the how, then preparation, because preparation is what saves people later in KYC.

Left out on purpose: video, live ticker, pop-ups, referral banner.

> The SEBI registration number is a placeholder. Compliance would add the real number.

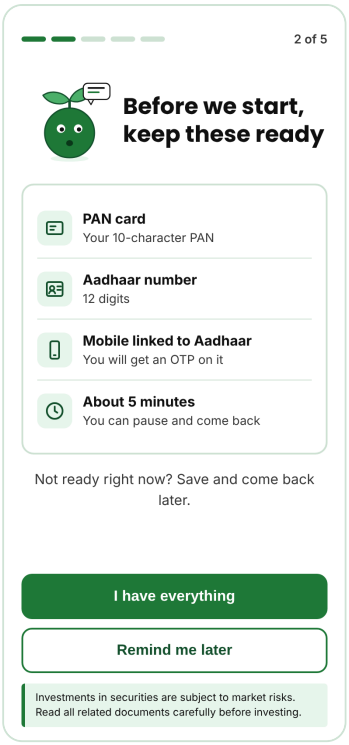
8 · Onboarding

The first 5 screens of the app



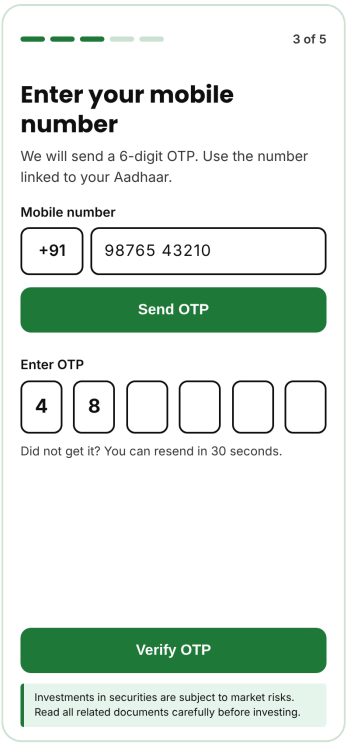
1 · Welcome

Mascot says hi and the ₹100 start. English selected, Hindi marked as coming soon.



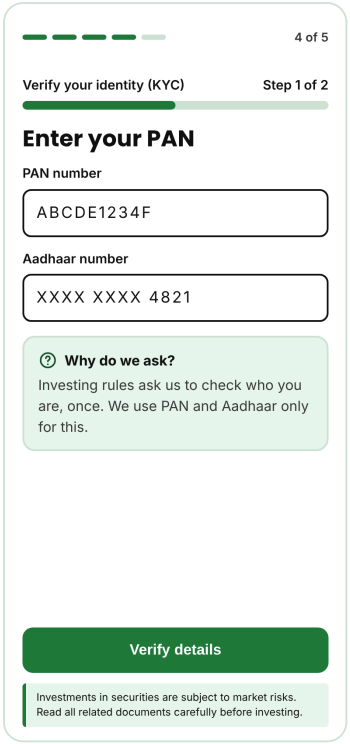
2 · What you need

PAN, Aadhaar, linked mobile, ~5 minutes, and a way to save and come back.



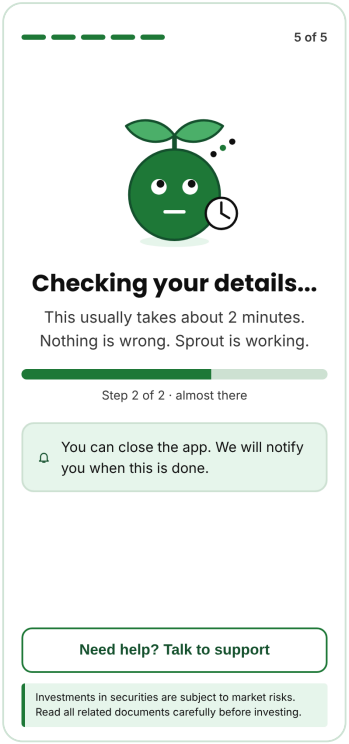
3 · Mobile and OTP

Big inputs and buttons, clear helper text, one task per screen.



4 · KYC

Progress bar, labels above boxes, and a "Why do we ask?" card.



5 · Verification wait

Mascot waiting, time estimate, progress, notify message and a help button.

One story

Same mascot, same green, same button and same disclaimer strip on every screen, so the homepage and the app feel like one product. The user is told what to do, why, and how long it takes.

9 · Rationale and checks

Why each screen looks the way it does

Screen	Design reason
Homepage	One message and one button for people who decide fast. Trust and the legal line sit in the hero so nothing is hidden. The checklist prepares users for KYC.
1 Welcome	A friendly first moment. The mascot introduces the ₹100 idea. Language choice is shown early even though Hindi comes later.
2 What you need	Fixes the "not ready" complaint before it happens. "Save and come back" removes pressure.
3 Mobile and OTP	Large inputs for small phones. Separate boxes for the OTP so it is easy to see.
4 KYC	Progress bar shows the end is near. The "why we ask" card answers the fear about sharing PAN and Aadhaar.
5 Waiting	Says plainly that nothing is wrong, shows an estimate and promises a notification. The mascot makes waiting feel like part of the story.

Quality checklist

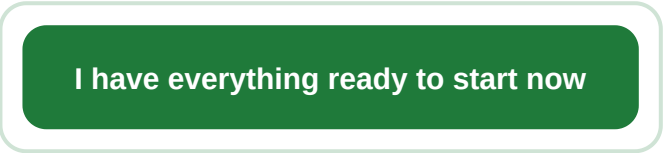
Check	Result
Risk disclaimer 12px or more, visible without scrolling	Yes. Hero strip on homepage, bottom strip on all 5 screens (12px).
No banned words anywhere	Checked all text on screens and in this document.
Contrast 4.5:1 normal, 3:1 large	Yes. Lowest text pair is green on light green at 4.8:1. Most are above 9:1.
Tap targets at least 44 x 44px	Buttons and inputs 52px tall, chips 44px.
Body text at least 16px on mobile	Yes. Helper text is 14px, only for small hints.
Layout survives ~30% longer text (Hindi)	Buttons stretch and wrap, no fixed widths on labels, cards grow with text.
Page under 1.5 MB (estimate below)	About 0.3 to 0.4 MB estimated.

Page-weight estimate

Part	Size
HTML + CSS	30 KB
JavaScript (basic)	120 KB
One web font (Noto Sans, 2 weights, subset)	70 KB
Mascot SVGs (4 states)	6 KB
Icons (SVG)	8 KB
Waiting animation (Lottie or CSS)	40 KB
Analytics and other	100 KB
Total (estimate)	**about 374 KB**

Estimated by me, not measured. It leaves a lot of room under the 1.5 MB limit.

Hindi test



A label about 30% longer wraps to two lines, the button just grows.

10 · Measuring and next steps

How we would know it works

Metric	Today	Goal idea (to agree with the team)
Download to KYC rate	22.5%	Move up step by step. This is the main number.
KYC completion	Drop-off of 62% reported	Fewer people quitting inside KYC, tracked per step.
Time to first investment	Not given	Measure it first, then reduce.
Homepage bounce (organic only)	78% (mixed with paid)	Split paid and organic, then improve organic.
Page load on 4G	6.2 s	Clearly lower than today on low-end phones.
Support tickets	Many about documents and "app crashed"	Fewer tickets on those two topics.

What I would test next

- **A/B test the waiting screen:** with mascot and time estimate vs plain spinner.
- **A/B test the "keep these ready" list:** on homepage only vs homepage + screen 2.
- **Talk to people who dropped off:** a short call or survey, because the current survey only has existing users.
- **Usability test with 5 people** on a low-end phone, including 2 Hindi speakers once Hindi copy exists.
- **Check wording with Compliance** (disclaimer text, "SEBI registered" chip, time estimate on the wait screen).

Design approach in 100 words

> The CEO wants a calm, premium look and Marketing wants a mascot, so I made Sprout a simple geometric seedling, not a cartoon. It is small on the homepage and bigger on onboarding screens where users feel nervous, like the KYC wait. For the CEO I used only green, white and black with lots of space. For Marketing I kept the mascot, added a celebration moment and moved the referral banner to after the first investment. I dropped the video, ticker and pop-ups because of load time and trust. Both sides get what matters most to them.

Limits of my work

No real user research was done. Personas, the time estimate on the wait screen and the page weight are assumptions. The next step would be to test them.